

not connected to each other, or not on a web server connected to the internet. What if you are a developer who is testing out various versions of his site and just needs to present his platform or web site to a client or a friend and show how the site would look before it actually goes live? It is all possible to do this by having a web server and the site installed on a USB Drive and if you have the ability to launch a web server on any computer. All this can be done without having to install any software onto that computer or host your web site online.



Setting up USB webserver

Traditionally to be able to launch a dynamic web site you would have to install a web server bundle onto a computer on which you would be working on. For this workshop we shall be considering the popular Apache, MySQL, PHP bundle. The bundle lets you host your pages and databases required by your web site on a local server. Similarly, while deploying your site on the internet you would need to lease or setup your own physical web server and the site would be accessible through a unique domain.

To make any changes to the site you would need to use an FTP client like File Zilla or WinSCP. With the convenience of being able to setup a web server on a USB stick though,



Install the latest version of Drupal

you can take your work anywhere you go and not have to install any software on the computer you are presenting or temporarily working on. But it is important to keep in mind that while a USB stick increases portability and convenience but is not the fastest way to run a web server.

Web Server on USB

USBWebserver is a bundle of major web software like Apache, MySQL, and PHP with additional features to help you run them from a USB device or simply a CD if necessary. Since it supports PHP, you can install popular software platforms like WordPress and Drupal onto it. We will be using Drupal later on in this workshop to illustrate the management of multiple domains. You can install the latest version of USBWebserver from www.usbwebserver.net.

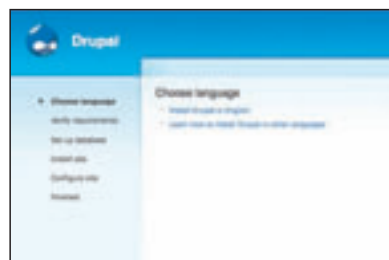
Once you have downloaded the file, all you need to do is unzip the file to extract the folder with the necessary files. Note that there is no actual installation required. To run the server it's as simple as executing the usbwebserver.exe file present in this folder. Executing the file will launch the Apache server along with

PHP My Admin and MySQL services. So basically all you have to do is copy this folder onto a USB device like a pen drive or an external hard disk and run USBWebserver.

Installing Drupal

Now let us look at installing Drupal onto this portable web server. Drupal is one of the leading open source content management systems primarily based to run on an Apache server running PHP. Download the most recent non development version of Drupal

from www.drupal.org. Drupal comes with a net web interface for easy quick installation of the package. Just unpack the contents of the downloaded file and place the contents of the file into the root directory of your USB web server. The file



Follow the on screen instructions for installing Drupal

should unpack into a drupal-x.x folder. You might have to change the permissions for this particular site so that the installation file will automatically create a new configuration file for drupal. Make sure that writing is allowed onto this directory by the web server. The easiest way to set permissions to make it writable is by `chmod o+w sites/default` on the web server.

Next up is creating a database specifically for Drupal. Create a new database through MySQLadmin by using the following command

```
mysqladmin -u db_user -p create drupalddb
```



Setting up site preferences

Now login to MySQL and set all permissions to allow the drupal installation to make the necessary changes to complete its installation

```
mysql -u db_user -p
GRANT ALL PRIVILEGES
ON drupalddb.* TO nobody@
localhost IDENTIFIED
BY 'password';
flush privileges;
```

Note that here the drupalddb is the database Drupal will be using to store its tables and 'nobody@localhost' will be your database account and the password for this database user will be 'password'. Make use of